

and have realised the need for scientifically designed products. D J Academy of Design alumni have successfully been placed in popular companies such as Infosys, Wipro Lighting, Tata Solar, Mahindra Tech and Onida.

If you want to pursue courses abroad, institutes such as Rhode Island School of Design (Rhode Island, USA), California Institute of the Arts (California, USA), Royal College of Art (London, UK) are options you could consider. Prof. Mukherjee advises

you try the best design school in the country, work for some time and then think of going abroad for a course in design. This way, he says, “you’ll be sure of your decision and have a better understanding of the subject rather than walking blindly on a lane”.

Design schools, in addition to imparting skills to students, perform the function of sorting probable designers. With enormous rush for admissions to design courses and the limited infrastructure in the nation, selection criteria need to be stringent and based on quality (read creativity and innovation) alone.

Deputy Registrar of MIT Vinayak Kulkarni adds, “The admission process begins in the month of November. The last date for submission of forms is January 31. This is followed by an All India test in the month of April. This is known as Design Aptitude Test. The next step is a studio test and personal interview in May, where further elimination is done. Finally classes begin in the month of July.”

Placement assistance

MIT Institute of Design started in 2006 and the first PG batch graduated in March 2009. According to Mukta Khanna, “Training and Placement

YOUR DESIGN KIT

As a designer, you’d need to have a toolkit. Industrial sculptor Paul Sandip has the following recommendations:



- Common sense, which is too uncommon
- Grey cells for sparking new connections
- Pencil (but no eraser, because every idea is worth trying out)
- Markers for attractive and informative communication.
- Rhinoceros 4.0 (or higher) or any other equivalent software for 3D visualisation.
- Hypershot for photo-realistic renderings